

John Ford

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ABOUT ME

29 years in Data Analysis, most of it spent on systems other teams depend on. Comfortable leading technical decisions, pushing back on scope when it matters, and carrying a pager for what I build. Primary tools: Spark and BigQuery.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Presented findings to the executive team monthly, translating analysis into concrete decisions.
- Modelled pricing scenarios in BigQuery, supporting a 18% margin improvement.
- Partnered with engineering to fix event tracking, recovering 40% of previously lost sessions.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Analyst

Cobalt Systems | Jan '08 – Jan '26

- Built data quality tests in Spark that catch upstream breakages before stakeholders see them.
- Designed the experiment readouts template now used company-wide.
- Defined and documented 40 core business metrics in the semantic layer, ending duplicate definitions.
- Trained 3 non-technical colleagues to self-serve, cutting ad-hoc request volume by 15%.

Analytics Engineer, BrightPath Solutions

Jan '99 – Dec '07

- Rebuilt the finance forecast with the FP&A; team, improving accuracy by 55%.
- Consolidated 12 legacy reports into 5 maintained dashboards.
- Analysed churn drivers and informed retention work that reduced churn by 40%.

Nova Tech Group — Business Intelligence Analyst

Jun '97 – Aug '98

- Automated monthly reporting with Redis, saving 5 analyst-hours per cycle.
- Migrated reporting from spreadsheets to SQL, giving one trusted source of numbers.

Junior Insights Analyst

Redwood Data | Jun '96 – Jun '97

- Built Tableau dashboards used daily by 3 stakeholders across three departments.
- Ran cohort analysis that reframed how the business measures activation.

Shopify — Junior Data Engineer

Dec '95 – Jun '96

- Led a team of 3 through a full replatforming with no missed delivery dates.
- Reduced technical debt on a legacy component that had blocked 3 previous attempts.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

Master, Information Systems

University of California, Berkeley | 1994 – 1995

Cum Laude

Bachelor, Mathematics

Fairview Institute of Technology | 1990 – 1994

KEY SKILLS

Spark (4 yr exp), BigQuery (2 yr exp), Python (2 yr exp), Excel (30 yr exp), PostgreSQL (4 yr exp), Power BI (7 yr exp), NumPy (16 yr exp), SQL (12 yr exp), Looker (11 yr exp), Pandas (28 yr exp), Tableau (21 yr exp), Terraform (16 yr exp), Swift (18 yr exp), Playwright (22 yr exp), PyTorch (26 yr exp), Redis (20 yr exp)

PROJECTS

Commute optimiser

Pulls transit APIs and suggests departure times, built on Terraform.

Charity chatbot

Built a Terraform assistant for a local charity to answer volunteer questions; retired it once they moved to a supported platform.

COMMUNITY

STEM ambassador running school workshops twice a term.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

English – C2

French – B2

Polish – C1